

BIOIA / WUOM

45 • THE THRESHOLD OF VISIBILITY

When does deterioration become a signal
capable of orienting?

2015

BARELY PERCEIVED

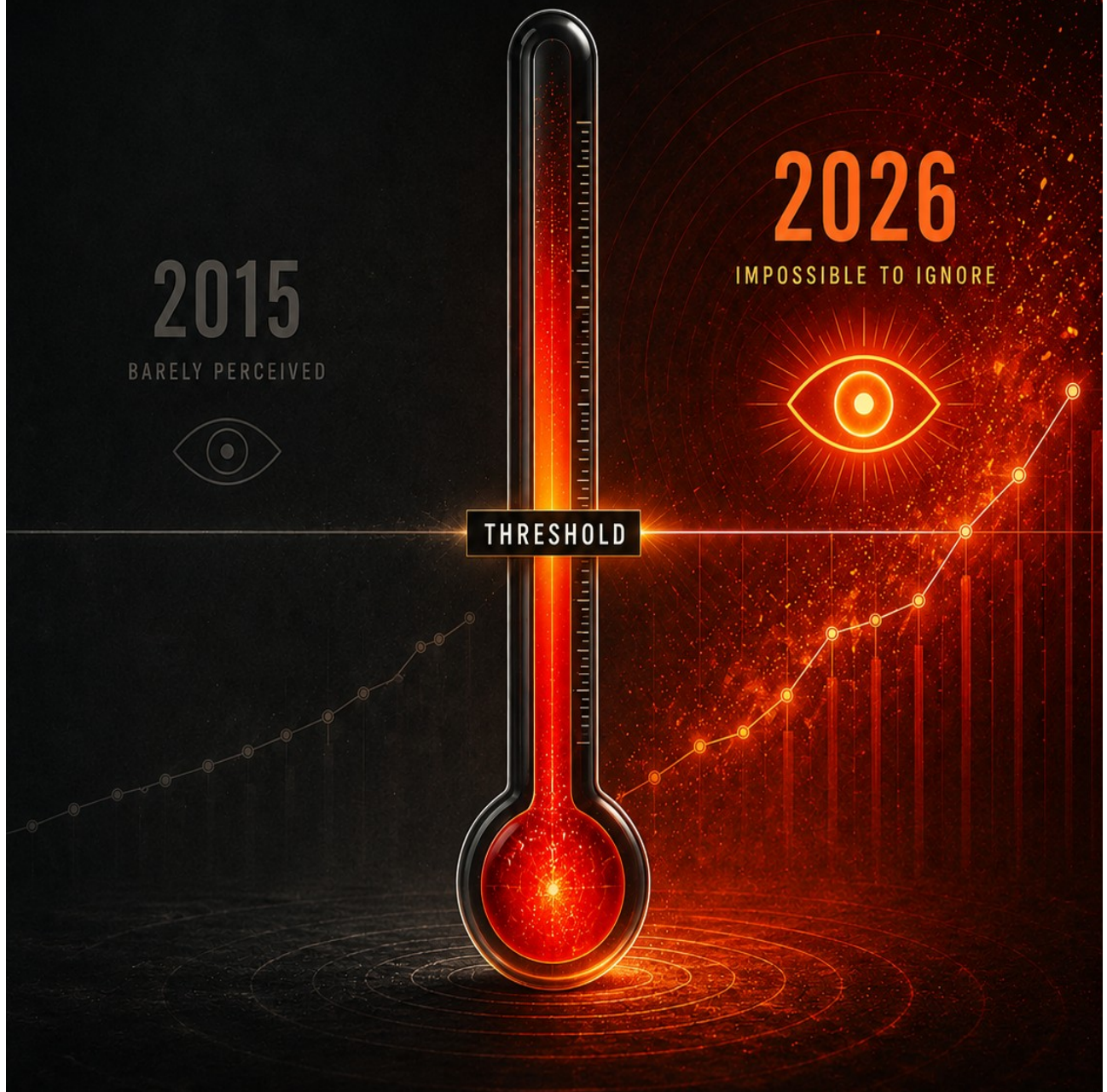


2026

IMPOSSIBLE TO IGNORE



THRESHOLD



THE THRESHOLD OF VISIBILITY

BIOIA / WUOM

THE SIGNAL WAS ALREADY THERE

Deterioration does not begin when we become capable of seeing it.

It can advance while the system continues to function, while indicators remain within what we still consider acceptable, and while each episode still appears explainable in isolation.

The thermometer introduces an essential distinction:

 **measuring is not the same as reading.**

A measurement can exist without yet becoming orientation.

We can record:

-  one temperature
-  another temperature
-  another summer
-  another episode

without yet having constructed a reading capable of relating them.

That is why there is a distance between data and signal:

DATA → REPETITION → PATTERN → SIGNAL

And another between signal and orientation:

SIGNAL → CONTEXT → READING → ORIENTATION

2015 → 2026

It does not mean:

2015 · we did not know

→

2026 · we know

The question is more uncomfortable:

how long can a signal remain in front of us before acquiring enough weight to reorganize our gaze?

   2015

↓

↓

 pattern

↓

  2026

Material reality can change gradually.

Our threshold of attention, however, can change suddenly.

BIOIA HYPOTHESIS

A signal does not necessarily appear when the phenomenon begins.

It may appear when an already existing alteration crosses our **threshold of legibility**.

The territory may be speaking before we construct a reading capable of listening to it.

The signal does not begin when we look at the thermometer.

It begins earlier.

The question is:

when do we stop seeing it as an isolated datum and begin reading it as a direction?

THE THRESHOLD IS NOT A LINE

We tend to imagine the threshold as an exact point:

before it could not be seen

|

THRESHOLD

|

afterwards it can be seen

But living systems rarely work this way.

Deterioration can become perceptible gradually, unevenly and fragmentarily. A signal may be evident to someone observing the territory while remaining secondary to someone who receives only isolated data.

That is why it is useful to speak of a:

WINDOW OF LEGIBILITY

INVISIBLE



↓

the alteration exists, but does not yet generate enough signal

PERCEPTIBLE



↓

something begins to stand out

LEGIBLE

👁️ + ⌚ + context

↓

the episodes can be related

ORIENTING



↓

the signal makes it possible to recognize a direction

THE THERMOMETER DOES NOT SET THE THRESHOLD BY ITSELF

 can measure.

But in order to read, we need to relate:

temperature + time + repetition + territory

An isolated value describes a condition.

A sequence can reveal a trajectory.

34 → 36 → 38 → 40

But even a numerical trajectory needs context.

The question is not only:

what does it read?

but:

what does it mean for it to read this here, now, and repeatedly?

BIOIA HYPOTHESIS

The visibility threshold does not depend only on a signal increasing.

It also depends on our ability to relate it.

Territory

+

Experience

+

Reading

↓

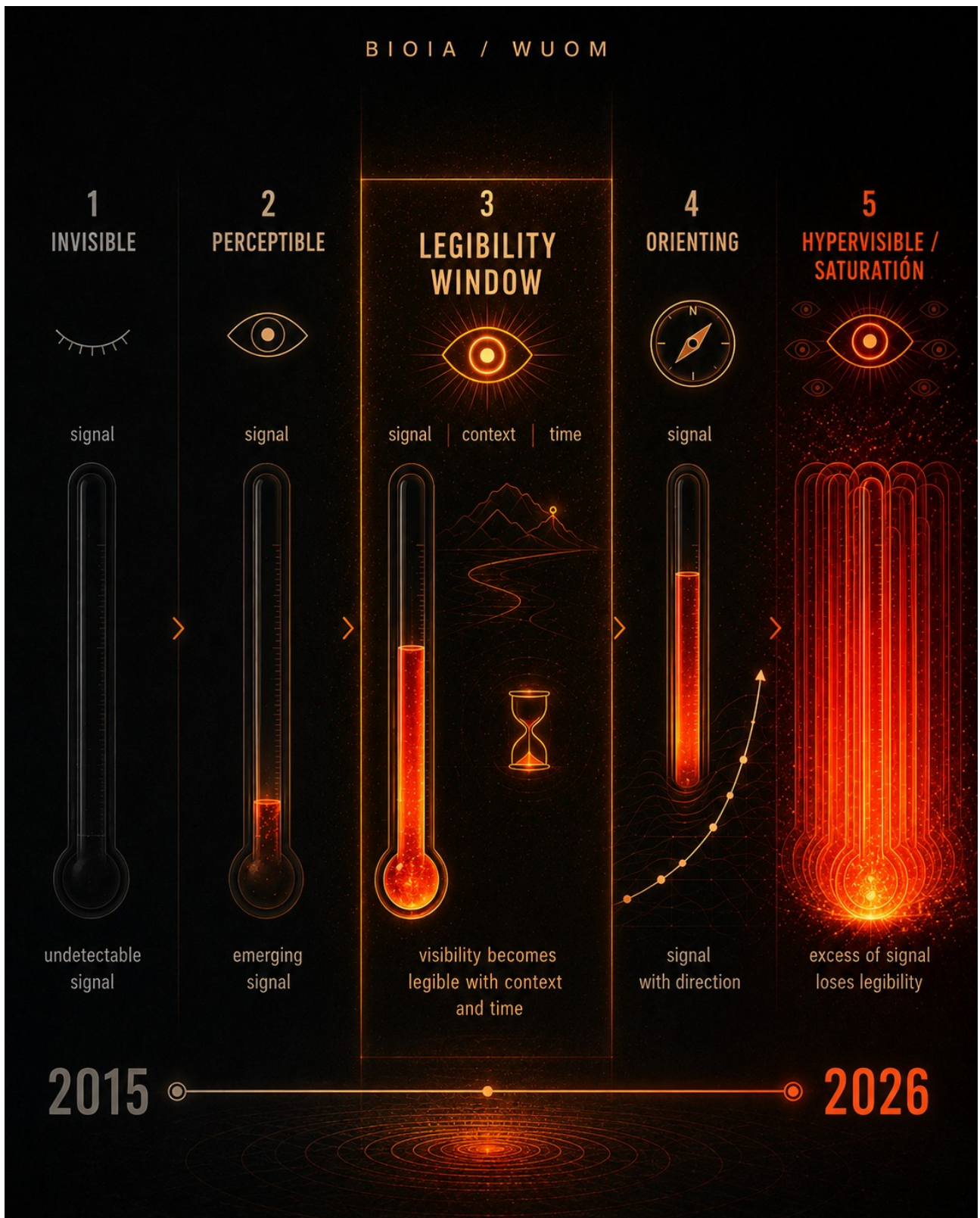
Orientation

That is why two observers can face the same signal without yet arriving at the same reading.

The threshold does not simply separate the invisible from the visible.

It separates something more important:

what we can perceive from what we can already begin to read.



LEGIBILITY WINDOW

WHEN THE SIGNAL OCCUPIES EVERYTHING

There is a second limit.

It does not appear before we can see the deterioration.

It appears afterwards.

When a signal repeats, intensifies and occupies more and more space, we might expect our ability to read it to increase in the same proportion.

But this does not necessarily happen.

MORE VISIBILITY ≠ MORE LEGIBILITY

FROM SIGNAL TO SATURATION

At first:



one datum

Then:



a pattern

Then:



a signal that is difficult to ignore

But if exceptionality becomes a continuous presence:



↓

repetition

↓

saturation

↓

normalization

The signal does not disappear.

It loses contrast.

HYPERVISIBILITY CAN ALSO CONCEAL

What is invisible can remain outside our attention because it barely appears.

What is hypervisible can occupy so much attention that we stop distinguishing:

- what is changing;
- relative to what;
- for how long;
- in which territory;
- and in which direction.

Then a paradox appears:

we constantly see the phenomenon, yet we may lose the ability to situate it.



THE THERMOMETER CHANGES POSITION

2015



one measurement among many



2026



heat repeatedly enters our experience, our maps, our records and our conversation.

The thermometer no longer needs to become visible.

The question changes:

are we still capable of reading what we see constantly?

BIOIA HYPOTHESIS

A signal orients while it retains sufficient relation to:

Territory · Time · Context

If those relations disappear beneath the volume of information, the signal may remain visible while losing its orienting capacity.

That is why the complete sequence is not:

INVISIBLE → VISIBLE → RESOLVED

but:

INVISIBLE → PERCEPTIBLE → LEGIBLE → ORIENTING → HYPERVISIBLE

and the final state can lead once again to a form of blindness:

not because the signal is absent, but because there is too much of it.

What is invisible may not be read because it cannot be seen.

What is hypervisible may not be read because it no longer allows anything else to be seen.

Between both extremes there is a window: the possibility of orienting ourselves.

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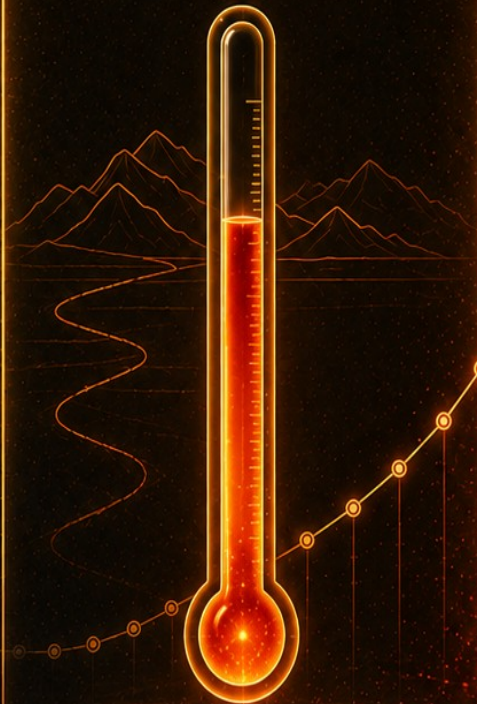
INVISIBLE

cannot be seen



ORIENTING

can be read



HYPERVISIBLE / SATURATION

excess of signal



Between both extremes there is a window:
the **possibility of orienting.**

Window of legibility between invisibility and hypervisibility.

BIOIA / WUOM, 2026.